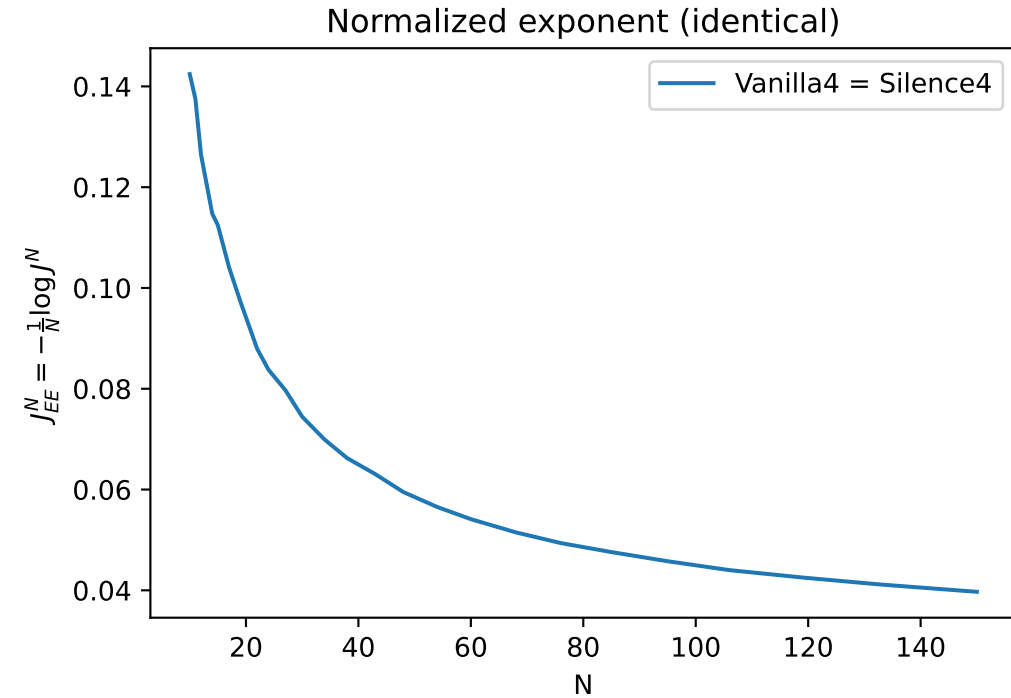
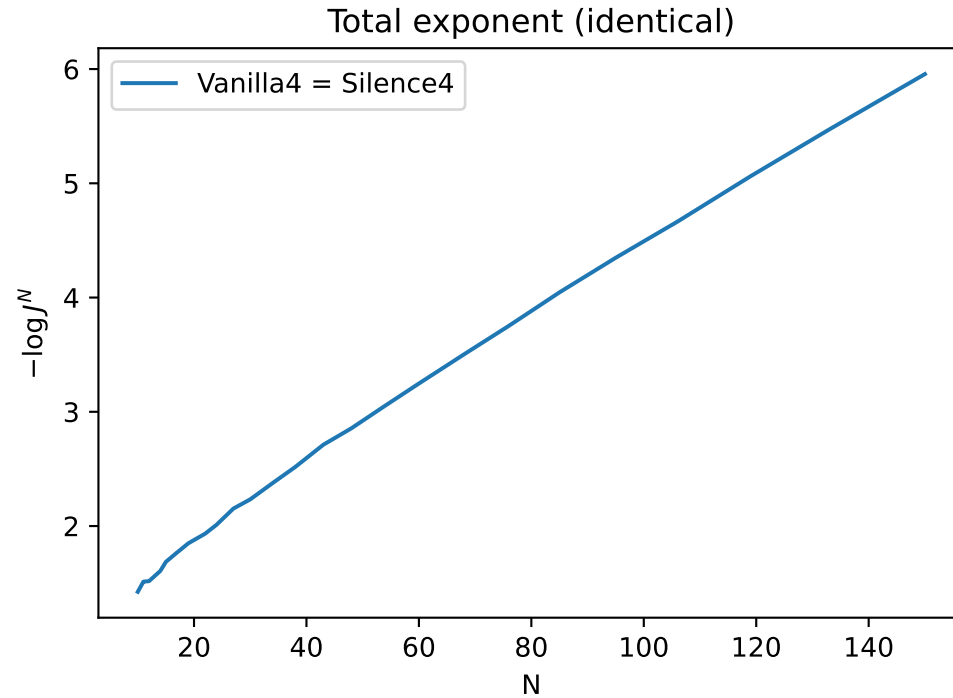
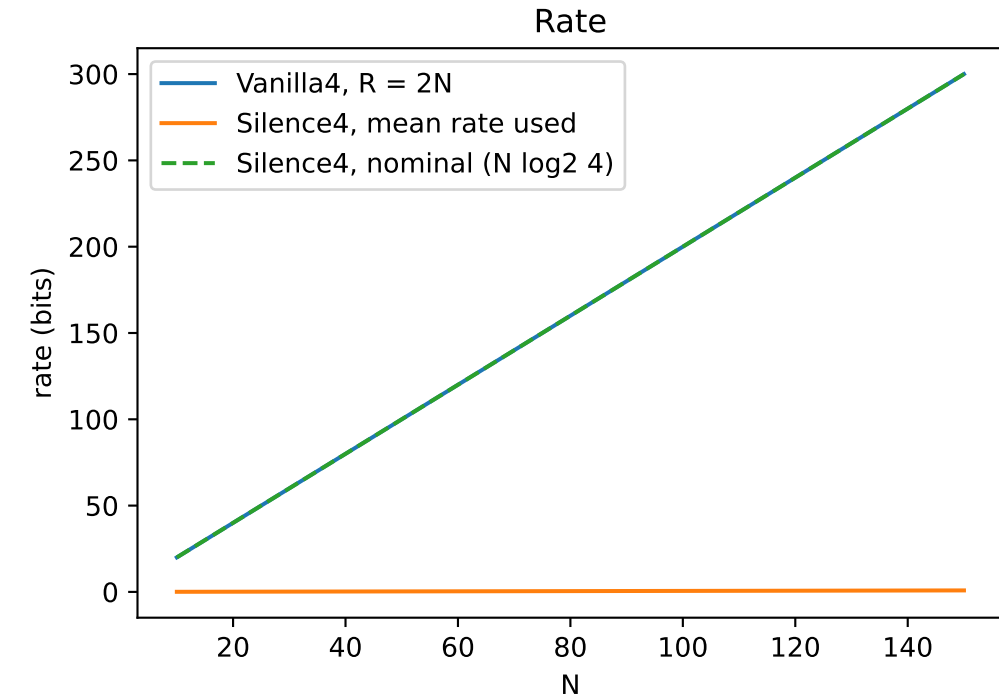


Vanilla-M4 vs. silence-M4 (two central bins free), SNR -5 dB



Vanilla4 and Silence4 achieve the exact same total exponent $-\log J^N$ (one curve, not two overlapping ones).
 Why: both use thresholds $\{0.2, 1, 5\}$ $\rightarrow$ identical channel $P(u|H)$; silence only zeroes the rate cost, never the FC's exact information.